

SANSKRIT • FROM DAY ONE

Phase 2

Dhātus, Finite Verbs, and Infinitives

A complete 20-day course for English-speaking beginners

Move from pronouns and basic present forms to precise two-verb sentences.
Learn each verb as a usable family, not as an isolated root.

STANDALONE COURSE • LESSONS • PRACTICE • ANSWERS • REFERENCE

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How to use this course

This is an independent Phase 2 course for English-speaking beginners who already recognize IAST, basic Devanāgarī, subject and object roles, pronouns, and the nine person-number cells of the present tense. Every Sanskrit teaching example appears in IAST first and Devanāgarī beside it.

Scope

This phase concentrates on present indicative finite verbs, verbal roots, infinitives, subject agreement, and objects. The word finite covers more than the present tense in Sanskrit as a whole; later phases can add other tense and mood systems.

Daily routine

1. Read the target and say the model forms aloud.
2. Copy each new lexical packet into a six-column verb notebook.
3. Cover the chart and retrieve the finite forms and infinitive.
4. Complete the written practice before opening the answer check.
5. Translate both directions: Sanskrit to English, then English to Sanskrit.
6. Pass the mastery check before moving to the next day.

What this course corrects

Informal phrase	Precise Sanskrit grammar term
"subject conjugation"	finite verb agreement with the subject
"object conjugation"	accusative declension or object marking
"conjugate a noun"	decline a noun or pronoun
"conjugate the infinitive"	keep the infinitive indeclinable; conjugate the finite verb
"add endings to the root"	form or learn a present stem, then add the correct endings

Before Day 1: five-minute bridge check

Practice

1. Which is the subject form: tvam or tvām?
2. Which is the object form: aham or mām?
3. Which ending matches vayam in regular parasmaipada present forms?
4. Which ending matches a 3rd-person dual subject?
5. In saḥ mām paśyati, what controls paśyati?

Answer check

1. tvam.
2. mām.
3. -maḥ.
4. -taḥ in parasmaipada.
5. saḥ, not mām.

If the bridge is difficult

Review Phase 1 pronouns, nominative/accusative roles, and the nine-cell present grid. Then return here. No new material depends on guessing.

The 20-day syllabus

The course is cumulative. Each day assumes the previous day's mastery check. If a check is not yet secure, repeat the lesson before adding new forms.

Day	Lesson	Primary control
1	Meet the verb family	dhātu, present stem, finite form, infinitive
2	Pronouns control agreement	subject versus object; person-number control
3	Nine-cell present grid	regular a-stem parasmaipada
4	Finite/non-finite architecture	one agreement anchor
5	Building infinitives	-tum, -itum, and lexical changes
6	Desire	complete icchati grid
7	Objects of infinitives	accusative marking
8	Ability	complete śaknoti grid
9	Movement packets	gam, āgam, sthā, nī
10	Perception and speech	ḍṛś, śru, vad, jñā
11	Doing and carrying	complete karoti grid; nī
12	Questions and negation	na, kim, kaḥ/kam, kutra
13	Coordinated actions	ca, api, multiple infinitives
14	Ātmanepada I	complete labhate grid
15	Ātmanepada II	complete sevate grid
16	Upasargas	prefixed lexical packets
17	Dictionary skills	P, Ā, class labels, entry extraction
18	Transformations	controlled changes and error diagnosis
19	Controlled reading	connected text
20	Capstone	parse, translate, transform, compose

Day 1: Meet the verb family

Learning target

Distinguish a dhātu, a present stem, a finite form, and an infinitive. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Four forms, four jobs

A Sanskrit dictionary may identify a verb by its **dhātu**, or verbal root. The root is a compact lexical core, conventionally marked with . It is not usually a word that can stand alone in a sentence. A present stem is the base used before present endings. A finite verb carries person and number. An infinitive is a non-finite, indeclinable form most often translated with English "to ...".

Feature	Finite present verb	Infinitive
Example	icchāmi - I want	gantum - to go
Person	yes: 1st person	no
Number	yes: singular	no
Ending set	yes: parasmaipada here	no
Time/mood	present indicative here	not finite
Role	anchors the clause	completes another verb

Learn a lexical packet

Do not memorize only gam "go." Learn the complete beginner packet: **gam** | **gaccha-** | **gacchati** | **gantum** | **parasmaipada** | **go**. The changes from gam to gaccha- and gantum show why guessing from the bare root is unreliable.

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
gam	gaccha-	gacchati	gantum	parasmaipada	go
paṭh	paṭha-	paṭhati	paṭhitum	parasmaipada	read, recite
likh	likha-	likhati	likhitum	parasmaipada	write
labh	labha-	labhate	labdhum	ātmanepada	obtain

Terminology repair

Nouns and pronouns **decline**; verbs **conjugate**. The infinitive does not conjugate. In **aham gantum icchāmi**, gantum stays fixed while icchāmi agrees with aham.

Practice

1. Label each item: **gam**, **gaccha-**, **gacchati**, **gantum**.
2. Which form can mean "to write": **likhati** or **likhitum**?
3. In **aham paṭhitum icchāmi**, which word marks 1st-person singular?

4. Why should gam, gaccha-, and gantum be learned together?

Answer check

1. dhātu; present stem; finite 3rd singular; infinitive.
2. **likhitum**.
3. **icchāmi**.
4. The present stem and infinitive are not predictable by merely adding endings to gam.

Mastery check

- I can explain why a dhātu is not automatically a sentence word.
- I can identify the finite verb and the infinitive in a two-verb expression.

Next step

Tomorrow you reconnect finite verbs to subject pronouns and separate subject agreement from object marking.

Day 2: Pronouns control finite agreement

Learning target

Match a subject pronoun to the correct present ending and keep object pronouns separate.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

The agreement rule

A finite Sanskrit verb agrees with its **subject** in person and number. It does not agree with the direct object. Nominative forms normally mark subjects; accusative forms normally mark direct objects.

Person	Subject: nominative	Object: accusative	Finite verb cue
1st singular	aham - I	mām - me	-mi
1st dual	āvām - we two	āvām - us two	-vaḥ / -vahe
1st plural	vayam - we	asmān - us	-maḥ / -mahe
2nd singular	tvam - you	tvām - you	-si / -se
2nd dual	yuvām - you two	yuvām - you two	-thaḥ / -ethe
2nd plural	yūyam - you all	yuṣmān - you all	-tha / -dhve
3rd singular	saḥ / sā / tat	tam / tām / tat	-ti / -te
3rd dual	tau / te / te	tau / te / te	-taḥ / -ete
3rd plural	te / tāḥ / tāni	tān / tāḥ / tāni	-nti / -nte

Watch the roles

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham tvām paśyāmi	अहं त्वां पश्यामि	I see you. aham is subject; tvām is object; paśyāmi agrees with aham.
tvam mām paśyasi	त्वं मां पश्यसि	You see me. tvam is subject; mām is object; paśyasi agrees with tvam.
saḥ tām paśyati	सः तां पश्यति	He sees her. saḥ is subject; tām is object; paśyati is 3rd singular.
vayam tān paśyāmaḥ	वयं तान् पश्यामः	We see them. vayam controls -maḥ; tān is masculine plural object.

No object agreement

Changing **mām** to **tvām** does not change a verb whose subject stays the same: **saḥ mām paśyati**; **saḥ tvām paśyati**.

Practice

1. Complete: **aham ... paśy___** (I see him). Use tam.

2. Complete: **tvam ... paśy___** (You see me).

3. Identify the controller of paśyāmaḥ in **vayaṃ yuṣmān paśyāmaḥ**.

4. Correct the agreement: **saḥ tāṃ paśyāmi**.

Answer check

1. ahaṃ taṃ paśyāmi.
2. tvam māṃ paśyasi.
3. **vayaṃ**, the nominative 1st-person plural subject.
4. **saḥ tāṃ paśyati**.

Mastery check

- I select a finite ending from the subject, never from the object.
- I can distinguish nominative tvam from accusative tvām.

Next step

Tomorrow you rebuild all nine regular parasmaipada present forms from one stem.

Day 3: The nine-cell present grid

Learning target

Conjugate a regular a-stem parasmaipada verb in all three persons and numbers. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

One stem plus nine endings

For a regular a-stem parasmaipada present, begin with a present stem such as **paṭha-**. The stem-final a combines with some endings: paṭha- + mi becomes **paṭhāmi**. Learn the whole forms, then notice the ending pattern.

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st - I/we	-mi	-vaḥ	-maḥ
2nd - you	-si	-thaḥ	-tha
3rd - he/she/it/they	-ti	-taḥ	-nti

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	paṭhāmi I read	paṭhāvaḥ we two read	paṭhāmaḥ we read
2nd	paṭhasi you read	paṭhathaḥ you two read	paṭhatha you all read
3rd	paṭhati he/she reads	paṭhataḥ they two read	paṭhanti they read

Transfer the pattern

The same endings work with **likha-** "write," **vada-** "speak," and **gaccha-** "go." The root may be irregular in how it forms the present stem, but once the stem is known, its endings may be regular.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
likhāvaḥ	लिखावः	We two write. 1st dual
vadatha	वदथ	You all speak. 2nd plural
gacchataḥ	गच्छतः	They two go. 3rd dual
paśyanti	पश्यन्ति	They see. 3rd plural from paśya-

Practice

1. Conjugate **likha-** for aham.
2. Conjugate **gaccha-** for yuvām.
3. Conjugate **paśya-** for te (they, masculine).

4. Change **tvam paṭhasi** to plural "you all."

5. Change **sah likhati** to dual "they two."

Answer check

1. **likhāmi.**
2. **gacchathaḥ.**
3. **paśyanti.**
4. **yūyam paṭhatha.**
5. **tau likhataḥ.**

Mastery check

- I can reproduce the nine parasmaipada endings from memory.
- I can conjugate from a known present stem without confusing the dhātu with the stem.

Next step

Tomorrow you learn why one finite verb can anchor a clause while an infinitive adds a second action.

Day 4: Finite and non-finite architecture

Learning target

Find the clause anchor and explain how an infinitive adds another action without a second agreement ending. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

One agreement anchor

A simple clause may contain two verb ideas but only one finite verb. In **aham gantum icchāmi**, *icchāmi* is finite: it tells us 1st person, singular, and present time. *gantum* contributes the action "to go" but carries no person or number.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham gantum icchāmi	अहं गन्तुम् इच्छामि	I want to go. gantum is fixed; icchāmi agrees with aham.
tvaṃ gantum icchasi	त्वं गन्तुम् इच्छसि	You want to go. same infinitive; 2nd singular finite verb.
sā gantum icchati	सा गन्तुम् इच्छति	She wants to go. same infinitive; 3rd singular finite verb.
vayaṃ gantum icchāmaḥ	वयं गन्तुम् इच्छामः	We want to go. same infinitive; 1st plural finite verb.

The understood doer

At this level, the subject of the finite verb is also understood as the doer of the infinitive: in *vayaṃ gantum icchāmaḥ*, "we" both want and go. Later Sanskrit study introduces constructions with more complex control.

Parsing routine

1. Circle the finite verb. 2. Read its person and number. 3. Find or infer its nominative subject. 4. Underline the infinitive. 5. Translate the finite verb plus "to ...".

Practice

1. Parse **yūyaṃ paṭhitum icchatha**: finite verb, infinitive, subject.

2. Change "I want to write" to "we two want to write."

3. Why does *likhitum* not become plural in the previous answer?

4. Translate: **tau gantum icchataḥ**.

Answer check

1. finite **icchatha**; infinitive **paṭhitum**; subject **yūyaṃ**.
2. **āvāṃ likhitum icchāvaḥ**.
3. An infinitive is indeclinable and has no person or number.
4. They two want to go.

Mastery check

- I can identify the single finite agreement anchor in a two-verb sentence.
- I leave the infinitive unchanged when I change the subject.

Next step

Tomorrow you study the two most visible infinitive shapes, -tum and -itum, without treating them as fully predictable.

Day 5: Building and learning infinitives

Learning target

Recognize common -tum and -itum infinitives and record them as part of each verb's lexical packet. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

The Classical Sanskrit infinitive

The productive Classical Sanskrit infinitive ends in **-tum**, sometimes with a connecting **-i-**, giving **-itum**. Historical sound changes and root strengthening can alter the base. Therefore, use patterns as memory aids but verify and memorize the infinitive with the verb.

Visible pattern	Examples	What to notice
base + -itum	paṭhitum, likhitum, vaditum, khāditum	A connecting i is visible.
changed base + -tum	gantum, kartum, draṣṭum, netum	The root changes before -tum.
short familiar form	pātum, dātum, sthātum, jñātum	A long ā appears in these packets.
consonant cluster	labdhum	Sound change produces -bdh-.

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
vad	vada-	vadati	vaditum	parasmaipada	speak
khād	khāda-	khādati	khāditum	parasmaipada	eat
kṛ	karo-/kuru-	karoti	kartum	parasmaipada	do, make
ḍṛś	paśya-	paśyati	draṣṭum	parasmaipada	see
nī	naya-	nayati	netum	parasmaipada	lead, carry
pā	piba-	pibati	pātum	parasmaipada	drink

Best notebook habit

Give every new verb one row with six fields: dhātu | present stem | 3rd singular | infinitive | pada | meaning. Color the infinitive, but never derive it by guesswork alone.

Practice

1. Pair **paṭhati** with its infinitive.

2. Pair **paśyati** with its infinitive.

3. Pair **nayati** with its infinitive.

4. Which part of vaditum is the visible connecting vowel?

5. Explain why gamitum should not be guessed from gam in this course.

Answer check

1. paṭhitum.
2. draṣṭum.
3. netum.
4. i.
5. The established beginner packet uses **gantum**; root-to-infinitive changes are not always transparent.

Mastery check

- I recognize both -tum and -itum shapes.
- I record an infinitive as vocabulary, not as a person-number form.

Next step

Tomorrow the finite verb icchati turns these infinitives into complete statements of desire.

Day 6: Desire with icchatī

Learning target

Conjugate icchatī and build complete sentences meaning want to do something. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Conjugation of iccha-

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	icchāmi	icchāvaḥ	icchāmaḥ
2nd	icchasi	icchathaḥ	icchatha
3rd	icchati	icchataḥ	icchanti

Sentence frame

SUBJECT + INFINITIVE + FINITE ICCHATI FORM

Sanskrit word order can vary, but this stable frame is excellent for beginning composition.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham paṭhitum icchāmi	अहं पठितुम् इच्छामि	I want to read. 1st singular
āvāṃ likhitum icchāvaḥ	आवां लिखितुम् इच्छावः	We two want to write. 1st dual
yūyaṃ khāditum icchatha	यूयं खादितुम् इच्छथ	You all want to eat. 2nd plural
tāḥ āgantum icchanti	ताः आगन्तुम् इच्छन्ति	They (f.) want to come. 3rd plural
bālau krīḍitum icchataḥ	बालौ क्रीडितुम् इच्छतः	The two boys want to play. 3rd dual subject noun

Pronoun dropping

Because icchāmi already signals "I," Sanskrit may omit aham: **paṭhitum icchāmi** still means "I want to read." Keep the pronoun while learning, then practice both versions.

Practice

- Compose: "You want to speak."
- Compose: "They two want to drink."
- Change **sā gantum icchati** to feminine plural.
- Translate: **vayaṃ draṣṭum icchāmaḥ**.
- Drop the explicit pronoun from "I want to write."

Answer check

1. tvam vadtum icchasi.
2. tau pātum icchataḥ.
3. tāḥ gantum icchanti.
4. We want to see.
5. likhitum icchāmi.

Mastery check

- I can conjugate iccha- in all nine cells.
- I can keep the infinitive constant while changing the subject and finite form.

Next step

Tomorrow you add direct objects to infinitive constructions and keep their accusative marking visible.

Day 7: Objects inside an infinitive phrase

Learning target

Mark the direct object of an infinitive with the accusative while the finite verb still agrees with the subject. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

The object keeps its job

An infinitive may govern the same kind of direct object as its finite verb family. Compare **pustakaṃ paṭhāmi** "I read a book" with **pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchāmi** "I want to read a book." Pustakam remains accusative because it is what is read.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchāmi	अहं पुस्तकं पठितुम् इच्छामि	I want to read a book. pustakam is neuter accusative singular.
tvam phalaṃ khāditum icchasi	त्वं फलं खादितुम् इच्छसि	You want to eat a fruit. phalam is neuter accusative singular.
sā tvāṃ draṣṭum icchati	सा त्वां द्रष्टुम् इच्छति	She wants to see you. tvām is 2nd-person singular object.
vayaṃ tān netum icchāmaḥ	वयं तान् नेतुम् इच्छामः	We want to lead them. tān is masculine accusative plural.
te māṃ draṣṭum icchanti	ते मां द्रष्टुम् इच्छन्ति	They want to see me. mām does not control icchanti.

Three-layer parse

Layer	Question	Example answer
Finite clause	Who wants?	sā - she
Finite agreement	Which form agrees?	icchati - 3rd singular
Infinitive phrase	See whom?	tvām - you, accusative

English trap

English word order alone does not mark these roles. Sanskrit endings do. Check -am, -ām, -ān and the irregular pronoun forms before translating.

Practice

1. Compose: "I want to see her."
2. Compose: "You want to read it." Use neuter tat.
3. Find the object: **te asmān draṣṭum icchanti**.
4. Correct: **mām tvāṃ draṣṭum icchāmi** for "I want to see you."

5. Translate: **yuvāṃ phalāni khāditum icchathaḥ**.

Answer check

1. ahaṃ tām draṣṭum icchāmi.
2. tvam tat paṭhitum icchasi.
3. asmān, "us."
4. ahaṃ tvām draṣṭum icchāmi.
5. You two want to eat the fruits.

Mastery check

- I can identify the subject, finite verb, infinitive, and infinitive's object.
- I do not let an accusative object control the finite ending.

Next step

Tomorrow you express ability with śaknoti, whose present stem has its own changing shape.

Day 8: Ability with śaknoti

Learning target

Use the finite forms of śak with an unchanged infinitive to say can or be able to. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

A changing present stem

The common ability verb śak uses forms built around **śakno-** / **śaknu-**. Learn its full present grid as a packet. The accompanying infinitive remains unchanged.

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	śaknomi	śaknuvaḥ	śaknumaḥ
2nd	śaknoṣi	śaknuthaḥ	śaknutha
3rd	śaknoti	śaknutaḥ	śaknuvanti
IAST transliteration		Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ paṭhitum śaknomi		अहं पठितुम् शक्नोमि	I can read. 1st singular ability verb
tvam likhitum śaknoṣi		त्वं लिखितुम् शक्नोषि	You can write. 2nd singular
sā gantum śaknoti		सा गन्तुम् शक्नोति	She can go. 3rd singular
āvāṃ kartum śaknuvaḥ		आवां कर्तुम् शक्नुवः	We two can do it. 1st dual
te vaditum śaknuvanti		ते वदितुम् शक्नुवन्ति	They can speak. 3rd plural

Do not regularize it

Forms such as *śakāmi are not the present forms taught here. Use the śakno-/śaknu- grid and retrieve whole forms.

Practice

- Compose: "We can read."
- Compose: "You two can go."
- Change **saḥ kartum śaknoti** to masculine plural.
- Translate: **ahaṃ tvāṃ draṣṭum śaknomi**.
- Which word changes in tvam/saḥ gantum ...?

Answer check

1. **vayaṃ paṭhituṃ śaknumaḥ.**
2. **yuvāṃ gantuṃ śaknuthaḥ.**
3. **te kartuṃ śaknuvanti.**
4. I can see you.
5. **śaknoṣi / śaknoti;** gantum stays fixed.

Mastery check

- I can use the nine finite forms of śak.
- I can contrast desire with icchati and ability with śaknoti.

Next step

Tomorrow you compare regular and irregular verb families through movement vocabulary.

Day 9: Movement packets

Learning target

Use gam and selected movement verbs without confusing roots, present stems, and infinitives. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Movement vocabulary

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
gam	gaccha-	gacchati	gantum	parasmaipada	go
ā + gam	āgaccha-	āgacchati	āgantum	parasmaipada	come
sthā	tiṣṭha-	tiṣṭhāti	sthātum	parasmaipada	stand, stay
nī	naya-	nayati	netum	parasmaipada	lead, carry

The prefix ā-

An **upasarga**, or verbal prefix, can reshape meaning. With gam, ā- gives the directional idea "come, approach": gacchati "goes" versus āgacchati "comes." The prefix remains part of the infinitive packet: gantum versus āgantum.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
saḥ grāmaṃ gacchati	सः ग्रामं गच्छति	He goes to the village. Destination is accusative.
sā gṛham āgantum icchati	सा गृहम् आगन्तुम् इच्छति	She wants to come home. āgantum is prefixed infinitive.
tau tatra sthātum icchataḥ	तौ तत्र स्थातुम् इच्छतः	They two want to stay there. tatra is indeclinable, "there."
ahaṃ bālaṃ gṛhaṃ netum icchāmi	अहं बालं गृहं नेतुम् इच्छामि	I want to lead the child home. bālaṃ is the person led.

Case note

A destination is often accusative in these beginner sentences: grāmaṃ gacchati "goes to the village." Do not translate every accusative as a direct object mechanically; interpret it with the verb.

Practice

1. Give the finite and infinitive packets for gam.

2. Compose: "They want to come."

3. Compose: "I can stay there."

4. Translate: yuvāṃ grāmaṃ gantum śaknuthaḥ.

5. Contrast gacchati and āgacchati.

Answer check

1. gacchati; gantum.
2. te āgantum icchanti.
3. ahaṃ tatra sthātum śaknōmi.
4. You two can go to the village.
5. goes versus comes/approaches; ā- adds direction toward.

Mastery check

- I learn prefixed verbs as complete lexical packets.
- I recognize an accusative destination with a motion verb.

Next step

Tomorrow perception and speech verbs expand both finite and infinitive sentence patterns.

Day 10: Seeing, hearing, and speaking

Learning target

Use perception and speech packets and parse their objects accurately. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

High-frequency packets

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
drś	paśya-	paśyati	draṣṭum	parasmaipada	see
śru	śṛṇo-/śṛṇu-	śṛṇoti	śrotum	parasmaipada	hear
vad	vada-	vadati	vaditum	parasmaipada	speak, say
jñā	jānā-	jānāti	jñātum	parasmaipada	know

These packets show four different relationships between root and present form. Use recognition first. Full conjugation of śṛṇoti and jānāti can be added after the regular grid is secure.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ tvāṃ draṣṭum icchāmi	अहं त्वां द्रष्टुम् इच्छामि	I want to see you. tvām is object of seeing.
sā gītaṃ śrotum icchati	सा गीतं श्रोतुम् इच्छति	She wants to hear the song. gītaṃ is neuter accusative.
te saṃskṛtaṃ vaditum śaknuvanti	ते संस्कृतं वदितुं शक्नुवन्ति	They can speak Sanskrit. saṃskṛtaṃ is accusative object/medium.
bālaḥ satyaṃ jñātum icchati	बालः सत्यं ज्ञातुम् इच्छति	The boy wants to know the truth. satyaṃ is neuter accusative.

Pronunciation focus

draṣṭum contains retroflex ṣṭ; śrotum begins with palatal ś; jñātum begins with the consonant cluster jñ. Read IAST slowly before using Devanāgarī.

Practice

1. Pair paśyati with its dhātu and infinitive.
2. Compose: "We want to hear the song."
3. Compose: "You can speak Sanskrit."
4. Translate: **sā satyaṃ jñātum icchati.**
5. Which form controls agreement in the previous sentence?

Answer check

1. dṛś; draṣṭum.
2. vyaṃ gītaṃ śrotum icchāmaḥ.
3. tvam saṃskṛtaṃ vaditum śaknoṣi.
4. She wants to know the truth.
5. icchati, controlled by sā.

Mastery check

- I can retrieve four perception/speech infinitives without guessing.
- I can mark and translate the object of the infinitive.

Next step

Tomorrow kṛ and nī show why irregular present forms and irregular infinitives must be learned independently.

Day 11: Doing and carrying

Learning target

Use *kṛ* and *nī* as high-frequency irregular packets and conjugate *karoti* in the present.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

The present of *kṛ*

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	karomi	kurvaḥ	kurmaḥ
2nd	karoṣi	kuruthaḥ	kurutha
3rd	karoti	kurutaḥ	kurvanti

The infinitive is **kartum**. Notice that the present alternates *karo-* / *kuru-* / *kurv-*, while the infinitive has *kar-*. This is one lexical family, not one mechanically unchanged stem.

Compare *nī*

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ kāryaṃ karomi	अहं कार्यं करोमि	I do the task. finite <i>kṛ</i>
ahaṃ kāryaṃ kartum icchāmi	अहं कार्यं कर्तुम् इच्छामि	I want to do the task. <i>kartum</i> is infinitive
te kāryaṃ kartuṃ śaknuvanti	ते कार्यं कर्तुं शक्नुवन्ति	They can do the task. <i>kurvanti</i> would be finite <i>kṛ</i> ; here <i>śaknuvanti</i> is finite
saḥ pustakaṃ nayati	सः पुस्तकं नयति	He carries the book. finite <i>nī</i> with <i>naya-</i>
saḥ pustakaṃ netum icchati	सः पुस्तकं नेतुम् इच्छति	He wants to carry the book. <i>netum</i> has strengthened vowel

Look-alike warning

In *te kāryaṃ kartuṃ śaknuvanti*, **kartum** is not finite. **śaknuvanti** supplies 3rd-person plural agreement. In *te kāryaṃ kurvanti*, **kurvanti** itself is the finite verb.

Practice

1. Conjugate *kṛ* for *vayam*.
2. Conjugate *kṛ* for *tau*.
3. Compose: "We want to do the work."
4. Compose: "You can carry the book."
5. Translate: **te pustakāni nayanti**.

Answer check

1. kurmaḥ.
2. kurutaḥ.
3. vayaṃ kāryaṃ kartum icchāmaḥ.
4. tvaṃ pustakaṃ netuṃ śaknoṣi.
5. They carry the books.

Mastery check

- I can conjugate the present of कृ from memory.
- I keep nayati/netum and karoti/kartum as paired vocabulary.

Next step

Tomorrow you use questions and negation without disturbing person-number agreement.

Day 12: Questions and negation

Learning target

Make yes-no questions, content questions, and negative infinitive constructions. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Negative statements

The indeclinable particle **na** negates the relevant finite verb or expression. In neutral beginner order, place it before the finite verb: **ahaṃ gantum na icchāmi** "I do not want to go." In continuous speech, vowel contact may be written with sandhi; this course keeps words separated for parsing.

Questions

A yes-no question can use **kim** as an interrogative particle at the beginning. A content question uses an appropriate interrogative form: **kaḥ** who (m. subject), **kam** whom (m. object), **kim** what, or **kutra** where.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
ahaṃ gantum na icchāmi	अहं गन्तुम् न इच्छामि	I do not want to go. na negates icchāmi.
saḥ likhituṃ na śaknoti	सः लिखितुं न शक्नोति	He cannot write. literally: is not able to write
kiṃ tvaṃ paṭhituṃ icchasi	कित्त्वं पठितुम् इच्छसि	Do you want to read? kim introduces yes-no question.
kaḥ gantum icchati	कः गन्तुम् इच्छति	Who wants to go? kaḥ is masculine nominative singular.
kam draṣṭuṃ icchasi	कं द्रष्टुम् इच्छसि	Whom do you want to see? kam is masculine accusative singular.
kutra gantum icchatha	कुत्र गन्तुम् इच्छथ	Where do you all want to go? kutra is indeclinable.

Keep agreement intact

Negation and question words do not replace the subject agreement rule. tvaṃ ... icchasi remains 2nd singular whether the sentence is positive, negative, or interrogative.

Practice

1. Negate: **sā gantum icchati**.

2. Ask: "Can you read?"

3. Ask: "Whom does he want to see?"

4. Ask: "Where do they want to go?"

5. Translate: **vayaṃ kartuṃ na śaknumaḥ**.

Answer check

1. sā gantum na icchati.
2. kiṃ tvam paṭhitum śaknoṣi?
3. kam saḥ draṣṭum icchati?
4. kutra te gantum icchanti?
5. We cannot do it.

Mastery check

- I can add na without changing the finite ending.
- I distinguish kaḥ as subject from kam as object.

Next step

Tomorrow you coordinate actions with ca and api and learn where these particles normally sit.

Day 13: More than one infinitive

Learning target

Coordinate two infinitives and preserve one clear finite agreement anchor. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

The particle ca

Ca means "and" and normally follows the word or phrase it connects. A useful beginner pattern is **INFINITIVE 1 + INFINITIVE 2 + ca + FINITE VERB**. Both infinitives remain non-finite.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham paṭhitum likhitum ca icchāmi	अहं पठितुं लिखितुं च इच्छामि	I want to read and write. ca follows the second coordinated infinitive.
sā draṣṭum śrotum ca icchati	सा द्रष्टुं श्रोतुं च इच्छति	She wants to see and hear. one finite icchati.
te gantum sthātum ca śaknuvanti	ते गन्तुं स्थातुं च शक्नुवन्ति	They can go and stay. one finite ability verb.
āvām kartum netum ca icchāvaḥ	आवां कर्तुं नेतुं च इच्छावः	We two want to do and carry. āvām controls icchāvaḥ.

The particle api

Api often means "also, too, even." It usually follows the item it focuses on: **aham api** "I too." Particle placement becomes subtler in advanced reading; begin with these transparent patterns.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
aham api gantum icchāmi	अहम् अपि गन्तुम् इच्छामि	I too want to go. api follows aham.
sā paṭhitum api icchati	सा पठितुम् अपि इच्छति	She also wants to read. api focuses the infinitive phrase.
te likhitum ca paṭhitum ca śaknuvanti	ते लिखितुं च पठितुं च शक्नुवन्ति	They can both write and read. repeated ca emphasizes both members.

Count finite verbs

In aham paṭhitum likhitum ca icchāmi, there are three verb ideas but only **one finite form**: icchāmi.

Practice

- Compose: "We want to read and write."
- Compose: "She too can speak."
- Underline the finite form: **te draṣṭum śrotum ca icchanti**.
- How many person-number endings occur in that sentence?

5. Translate: **āvāṃ gantum sthātum ca śaknuvaḥ.**

Answer check

1. **vayaṃ paṭhitum likhitum ca icchāmaḥ.**
2. **sā api vaditum śaknoti.**
3. **icchanti.**
4. One, on icchanti.
5. We two can go and stay.

Mastery check

- I can coordinate infinitives with postpositive ca.
- I can use api in a transparent beginner position.

Next step

Tomorrow you meet ātmanepada finite endings and learn why the infinitive still does not reveal the pada.

Day 14: Ātmanepada finite endings

Learning target

Conjugate labhate and separate an ending set from an infinitive's shape. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

A second present ending set

Some verbs take **ātmanepada** endings in the forms learned here. The label is grammatical; do not force a single English meaning such as "for oneself" onto every occurrence. Learn the pada with the lexical packet.

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	labhe	labhāvahe	labhāmahe
2nd	labhase	labhethe	labhadhve
3rd	labhate	labhete	labhante
IAST transliteration		Devanāgarī	English / note
aham phalaṃ labhe		अहं फलं लभे	I obtain a fruit. 1st singular ātmanepada
yuvāṃ phale labhethe		युवां फले लभेथे	You two obtain two fruits. 2nd dual
te pustakāni labhante		ते पुस्तकानि लभन्ते	They obtain books. 3rd plural
sā phalaṃ labdhum icchatī		सा फलं लब्धुम् इच्छति	She wants to obtain a fruit. labdhum has no pada ending
vayaṃ pustakāni labdhum śaknumaḥ		वयं पुस्तकानि लब्धुं शक्नुमः	We can obtain books. śaknumaḥ is finite parasmaipada

Crucial distinction

The infinitive **labdhum** does not carry ātmanepada person-number endings. Its lexical packet tells you that the finite present is labhate, but the infinitive itself is non-finite.

Practice

1. Conjugate labha- for aham.
2. Conjugate labha- for yūyam.
3. Conjugate labha- for tāḥ.
4. Compose: "I want to obtain the book."
5. Which word shows parasmaipada in **te labdhum śaknuvanti**?

Answer check

1. labhe.
2. labhadhve.
3. labhante.
4. ahaṃ pustakaṃ labdhum icchāmi.
5. śaknuvanti.

Mastery check

- I can produce the nine present forms of labhate.
- I do not assign person, number, or pada endings to an infinitive.

Next step

Tomorrow a second ātmanepada packet, sevate, helps you compare regular finite formation with infinitive formation.

Day 15: A second ātmanepada family

Learning target

Use sevate as a regular ātmanepada model and compare finite and infinitive sentences. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Conjugation of seva-

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	seve	sevāvahe	sevāmahe
2nd	sevase	sevethe	sevadhve
3rd	sevate	sevete	sevante

sev | seva- | sevate | sevitum | ātmanepada | serve, attend, practice. Unlike labdhum, the infinitive sevitum visibly uses -itum. The finite ending set and the infinitive formation are independent facts in the packet.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
śiṣyaḥ guruṃ sevate	शषियः गुरुं सेवते	The student serves the teacher. guruṃ is accusative object.
śiṣyau guruṃ sevete	शषियौ गुरुं सेवेते	The two students serve the teacher. 3rd dual ātmanepada.
śiṣyāḥ guruṃ sevante	शषियाः गुरुं सेवन्ते	The students serve the teacher. 3rd plural.
ahaṃ guruṃ sevitum icchāmi	अहं गुरुं सेवतिम् इच्छामि	I want to serve the teacher. icchāmi is finite.
vayaṃ yogaṃ sevitum śaknumaḥ	वयं योगं सेवतिं शक्नुमः	We can practice yoga. contextual sense of sev.

Translation range

A Sanskrit root may have several related English meanings. Choose the translation that fits its object and context; do not assume one English gloss works everywhere.

Practice

1. Conjugate seva- for āvām.

2. Conjugate seva- for te.

3. Give the infinitive of sevate.

4. Compose: "They want to serve the teacher."

5. Identify all roles in sā yogaṃ sevitum śaknoti.

Answer check

1. sevāvahe.
2. sevante.
3. sevitum.
4. te guruṃ sevitum icchanti.
5. sā subject; yogam object; sevitum infinitive; śaknoti finite.

Mastery check

- I can use two ātmanepada lexical packets: labhate/labdhum and sevate/sevitum.
- I can recognize the finite ending set even when another verb supplies the infinitive.

Next step

Tomorrow upasargas become a systematic vocabulary tool rather than isolated prefixes.

Day 16: Upasargas and lexical meaning

Learning target

Analyze a verbal prefix while continuing to learn each prefixed verb as a complete packet. Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

Prefix plus root is a new vocabulary item

An **upasarga** precedes a verbal root and may add direction, aspect, or an idiomatic meaning. The result is not always the sum of simple English glosses. Record the prefix, root, present form, and infinitive together.

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
ā + gam	āgaccha-	āgacchati	āgantum	parasmaipada	come
pra + viś	praviśa-	praviśati	praveṣṭum	parasmaipada	enter
upa + viś	upaviśa-	upaviśati	upaveṣṭum	parasmaipada	sit down

The forms praveṣṭum and upaveṣṭum again show that an infinitive may not look like the present stem. Prefixes remain attached in both finite and infinitive members of the packet.

IAST transliteration	Devanāgarī	English / note
saḥ grhaṃ praviśati	सः गृहं प्रवशिति	He enters the house. grhaṃ is accusative destination.
sā grhaṃ praveṣṭum icchati	सा गृहं प्रवेष्टुम् इच्छति	She wants to enter the house. prefixed infinitive
bālāḥ upaviśanti	बालाः उपवशिनृति	The children sit down. regular endings on upaviśa-
yūyam upaveṣṭum śaknutha	यूयम् उपवेष्टुं शकनुथ	You all can sit down. upaveṣṭum remains fixed

Safe learning rule

Analyze the parts, but memorize the whole. Prefix analysis helps recognition; the lexical packet protects you from incorrect forms and overly literal meanings.

Practice

1. Give the infinitive paired with praviśati.
2. Give the finite 3rd singular paired with upaveṣṭum.
3. Compose: "We want to enter the house."
4. Compose: "You can sit down."
5. Explain what stays visible across praviśati/praveṣṭum.

Answer check

1. praveṣṭum.
2. upaviśati.
3. vyaṃ grhaṃ praveṣṭum icchāmaḥ.
4. tvaṃ upaveṣṭum śaknoṣi.
5. The prefix **pra-** and the lexical identity of viś, despite stem changes.

Mastery check

- I recognize that a prefixed verb needs its own lexical packet.
- I can keep a prefix attached when changing from finite form to infinitive.

Next step

Tomorrow you practice reading dictionary-style entries and choosing only the fields needed for a sentence.

Day 17: Read a verb entry

Learning target

Extract a root, present form, pada, meaning, and infinitive from a compact learner entry.
Suggested study time: 45-60 minutes.

A learner-friendly entry

Model entry

gam (1P) **gacchati** "go"; infinitive **gantum**.
Read it as: root gam; traditional class 1; parasmaipada; 3rd singular present gacchati; meaning go; infinitive gantum.

Dictionaries differ in notation. **P** commonly abbreviates parasmaipada; **Ā** commonly abbreviates ātmanepada; **U** may indicate that both sets occur in appropriate usage. A class number identifies a traditional present-system formation. At this stage, use class and pada labels to interpret an entry, not to generate unseen forms blindly.

Entry	Extracted packet
paṭh (1P) paṭhati ; paṭhitum	paṭh paṭha- paṭhati paṭhitum P read
kṛ (8P) karoti ; kartum	kṛ karo-/kuru- karoti kartum P do
labh (1Ā) labhate ; labdhum	labh labha- labhate labdhum Ā obtain
sev (1Ā) sevate ; sevitum	sev seva- sevate sevitum Ā serve

From entry to sentence

To make "they read," choose the present stem and 3rd-person plural P ending: **paṭhanti**. To make "they want to read," use the stored infinitive and conjugate icchati: **te paṭhitum icchanti**.

Verification habit

When a root has an unexpected stem, several meanings, more than one pada, or a prefixed form, consult a reliable grammar or dictionary and copy an attested packet.

Practice

- Expand: **ḍṛś** (1P) **paśyati**; **draṣṭum**.
- What does **Ā** tell you in a learner entry?
- What does a class number mainly identify?
- Use the entry **labh** (1Ā) **labhate**; **labdhum** to say "they obtain."
- Use the same entry to say "they want to obtain."

Answer check

1. dṛś | paśya- | paśyati | draṣṭum | P | see.
2. The cited finite forms use ātmanepada endings.
3. A traditional pattern for forming the present system.
4. **te labhante.**
5. **te labdhum icchanti.**

Mastery check

- I can read P and Ā labels without assigning them to the infinitive as endings.
- I can turn a compact entry into a six-field lexical packet.

Next step

Tomorrow you transform sentences systematically across subject, number, polarity, and verb architecture.

Day 18: Transformation laboratory

Learning target

Change one feature at a time and preserve every unaffected case and agreement relation.
Suggested study time: 60 minutes.

A disciplined transformation sequence

Step	Instruction	Result
Base	I read the book.	ahaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhāmi
Add desire	I want to read the book.	ahaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchāmi
Change subject	We two want to read the book.	āvāṃ pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchāvaḥ
Change object	We two want to read the books.	āvāṃ pustakāni paṭhitum icchāvaḥ
Change polarity	We two do not want to read the books.	āvāṃ pustakāni paṭhitum na icchāvaḥ
Change to ability	We two cannot read the books.	āvāṃ pustakāni paṭhitum na śaknuvaḥ

Error diagnosis

Faulty form	Diagnosis	Repair
*ahaṃ gantum icchati	3rd singular finite verb with 1st singular subject	ahaṃ gantum icchāmi
*te gantum icchati	singular finite verb with plural subject	te gantum icchanti
*sā tvam draṣṭum icchati	object pronoun is nominative	sā tvāṃ draṣṭum icchati
*vayaṃ gamtum icchāmaḥ	guessed infinitive	vayaṃ gantum icchāmaḥ
*te pustakāni paṭhanti icchanti	two unintended finite anchors	te pustakāni paṭhitum icchanti

Check in this order

1. Subject case. 2. Subject person and number. 3. Finite ending. 4. Object case. 5. Infinitive packet. 6. Particle placement. This order prevents one correction from hiding another.

Practice

1. Change saḥ phalaṃ khādati to "He wants to eat the fruit."

2. Then make the subject feminine plural.

3. Then make the object plural.

4. Then change desire to negative ability.

5. Diagnose *mām paṭhitum icchāmi for "I want to read."

Answer check

1. saḥ phalaṃ khāditum icchati.
2. tāḥ phalaṃ khāditum icchanti.
3. tāḥ phalāni khāditum icchanti.
4. tāḥ phalāni khāditum na śaknuvanti.
5. mām is accusative; use nominative **aham** or omit it.

Mastery check

- I can transform a sentence without changing unrelated roles.
- I can diagnose agreement, case, and infinitive errors separately.

Next step

Tomorrow you read a controlled passage containing finite verbs, infinitives, objects, questions, and negation.

Day 19: Controlled reading

Learning target

Read a short transliteration-first passage, parse its verb architecture, and answer in Sanskrit. Suggested study time: 60 minutes.

Read in two scripts

IAST:

rāmaḥ sītā ca grāme vasataḥ. adya tau nagaraṃ gantum icchataḥ. rāmaḥ pustakāni kretum icchati, kintu sītā mitraṃ draṣṭum icchati. tau prātaḥ gantum na śaknutaḥ. madhyāhne tau nagaraṃ gacchataḥ. rāmaḥ pustakāni labhate. sītā mitraṃ draṣṭum śaknoti. tataḥ tau grāham āgantum icchataḥ.

रामः सीता च ग्रामे वसतः। अद्य तौ नगरं गन्तुम् इच्छतः। रामः पुस्तकानि क्रेतुम् इच्छति किन्तु सीता मित्रं द्रष्टुम् इच्छति। तौ प्रातः गन्तुम् न शक्नुतः। मध्याह्ने तौ नगरं गच्छतः। रामः पुस्तकानि लभते। सीता मित्रं द्रष्टुं शक्नोति। ततः तौ ग्रहम् आगन्तुम् इच्छतः।

Vocabulary support

Form	Meaning	Note
grāme	in the village	locative singular
adya	today	indeclinable
kretum	to buy	infinitive of krī
kintu	but	indeclinable
prātaḥ	in the morning	indeclinable
madhyāhne	at midday	locative singular
tataḥ	then, from there	indeclinable

Reading strategy

First mark every finite ending. Then underline infinitives. Only afterward resolve subjects, objects, time words, and connectors.

Practice

1. Where do Rāma and Sītā live?

2. What does Rāma want to buy?

3. Whom does Sītā want to see?

4. Why is śaknutaḥ dual?

5. List all infinitives in order.

6. Which finite verb is ātmanepada?

Answer check

1. They live in the village: **tau grāme vasataḥ**.
2. Books: **rāmaḥ pustakāni kretum icchati**.
3. A friend: **sītā mitraṃ draṣṭum icchati**.
4. Its subject is **tau**, Rāma and Sītā.
5. **gantum, kretum, draṣṭum, gantum, draṣṭum, āgantum**.
6. **labhate**.

Mastery check

- I can separate finite and non-finite forms in connected text.
- I use endings and case forms before relying on English-like word order.

Next step

Tomorrow's capstone asks you to parse, transform, translate, and compose independently.

Day 20: Capstone

Learning target

Demonstrate independent control of lexical packets, finite agreement, infinitives, pronoun case, and two-verb sentences. Suggested study time: 75-90 minutes.

Part A: Label and retrieve

For each packet, label dhātu, present stem, finite 3rd singular, infinitive, pada, and meaning. Then cover the row and reproduce it from the root.

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
gam	gaccha-	gacchati	gantum	parasmaipada	go
ḍṛś	paśya-	paśyati	draṣṭum	parasmaipada	see
kṛ	karo-/kuru-	karoti	kartum	parasmaipada	do
labh	labha-	labhate	labdhum	ātmanepada	obtain
sev	seva-	sevate	sevitum	ātmanepada	serve

Part B: Parse

Practice

1. Parse every role in **te asmān draṣṭum icchanti**.

2. Parse every role in **āvāṃ pustakāni labdhum śaknuvaḥ**.

3. Explain why sevitum does not reveal a person-number ending.

Answer check

1. te subject, 3rd plural; asmān object, 1st plural accusative; draṣṭum infinitive; icchanti finite 3rd plural.
2. āvāṃ subject, 1st dual; pustakāni neuter plural object; labdhum infinitive; śaknuvaḥ finite 1st dual.
3. It is a non-finite, indeclinable infinitive.

Part C: Transform and compose

Practice

1. Transform "She reads the book" into "She wants to read the book."

2. Make it a yes-no question.

3. Change it to "They cannot read the books."

4. Compose: "We two want to come and see you."

5. Compose: "You all want to obtain the fruits."

Answer check

1. sâ pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchati.
2. kiṃ sâ pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchati?
3. te pustakāni paṭhitum na śaknuvanti.
4. āvāṃ āgantum tvāṃ draṣṭum ca icchāvaḥ.
5. yūyaṃ phalāni labdhum icchatha.

Part D: Self-assessment

Skill	Not yet	With a chart	Independently
Identify root, stem, finite form, infinitive			
Conjugate regular parasmaipada present			
Conjugate labhate and sevate			
Select subject versus object pronouns			
Build desire and ability sentences			
Read a short connected passage			

Completion standard

You are ready for the next phase when you score at least 80 percent on the capstone without looking at the answer checks and can explain every correction aloud.

Reference: Pronouns and agreement

Use this section after attempting a sentence from memory. The nominative column selects the finite person-number ending; the accusative column marks a direct object.

Person	Subject: nominative	Object: accusative	Finite verb cue
1st singular	aham - I	mām - me	-mi
1st dual	āvām - we two	āvām - us two	-vaḥ / -vahe
1st plural	vayam - we	asmān - us	-maḥ / -mahe
2nd singular	tvam - you	tvām - you	-si / -se
2nd dual	yuvām - you two	yuvām - you two	-thaḥ / -ethe
2nd plural	yūyam - you all	yuṣmān - you all	-tha / -dhve
3rd singular	saḥ / sā / tat	tam / tām / tat	-ti / -te
3rd dual	tau / te / te	tau / te / te	-taḥ / -ete
3rd plural	te / tāḥ / tāni	tān / tāḥ / tāni	-nti / -nte

Parasmaipada present endings

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st - I/we	-mi	-vaḥ	-maḥ
2nd - you	-si	-thaḥ	-tha
3rd - he/she/it/they	-ti	-taḥ	-nti

Ātmanepada present endings

Person	Singular	Dual	Plural
1st	-e	-āvahe	-āmahe
2nd	-se	-ethe	-dhve
3rd	-te	-ete	-nte

Reference: Core lexical packets

Dhātu	Present stem	3rd sg. finite	Infinitive	Pada	Meaning
gam	gaccha-	gacchati	gantum	P	go
ā + gam	āgaccha-	āgacchati	āgantum	P	come
bhū	bhava-	bhavati	bhavitum	P	become, be
paṭh	paṭha-	paṭhati	paṭhitum	P	read
likh	likha-	likhati	likhitum	P	write
vad	vada-	vadati	vaditum	P	speak
khād	khāda-	khādati	khāditum	P	eat
pā	piba-	pibati	pātum	P	drink
ḍṛś	paśya-	paśyati	draṣṭum	P	see
śru	śṛṇo-/śṛṇu-	śṛṇoti	śrotum	P	hear
kṛ	karo-/kuru-	karoti	kartum	P	do, make
nī	naya-	nayati	netum	P	lead, carry
sthā	tiṣṭha-	tiṣṭhati	sthātum	P	stand, stay
jñā	jānā-	jānāti	jñātum	P	know
labh	labha-	labhate	labdhum	Ā	obtain
sev	seva-	sevate	sevitum	Ā	serve, practice
pra + viś	praviśa-	praviśati	praveṣṭum	P	enter
upa + viś	upaviśa-	upaviśati	upaveṣṭum	P	sit down

Abbreviations

P = parasmaipada; **Ā** = ātmanepada. These labels describe the finite ending set used in the cited present forms.

Reference: Sentence builders

Purpose	Stable beginner frame	Example
Simple finite action	SUBJECT + OBJECT + FINITE VERB	ahaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhāmi
Desire	SUBJECT + OBJECT + INFINITIVE + ICCHATI	ahaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhitum icchāmi
Ability	SUBJECT + OBJECT + INFINITIVE + ŚAKNOTI	ahaṃ pustakaṃ paṭhitum śaknōmi
Negation	... + INFINITIVE + NA + FINITE VERB	ahaṃ gantum na icchāmi
Yes-no question	KIM + ... + FINITE VERB	kiṃ tvam gantum icchasi?
Two actions	INF. 1 + INF. 2 + CA + FINITE VERB	paṭhitum likhitum ca icchāmi

Final parsing checklist

1. Locate the finite verb and read its person, number, and ending set.
2. Find or infer the nominative subject that controls it.
3. Identify every infinitive; do not assign it person or number.
4. Mark accusative objects and destinations according to the governing verb.
5. Check particles, prefixes, and the exact lexical packet.
6. Translate only after the Sanskrit structure is clear.

Sources and conventions

The explanations and exercises in this book are original. The grammatical conventions were checked against the following reference works and resources.

- **William Dwight Whitney, Sanskrit Grammar**, Chapter XIII, especially sections 968, 972, and 981 on the Classical Sanskrit infinitive in -tum/-itum and its use as a verbal object. Open the public-domain text.
- **A. A. Macdonell, A Sanskrit Grammar for Students**. Used as a general reference for present-system terminology, person-number endings, and verbal forms.
- **The Sanskrit Heritage Site, INRIA**. Used as a cross-checking resource for lexical and inflectional forms. Open Sanskrit Heritage.

Course conventions

- **IAST first**: transliteration carries the main teaching load; Devanāgarī reinforces script recognition.
- **Pedagogical word separation**: some examples keep words separated where fully applied external sandhi could join or alter them.
- **Present focus**: "finite form" in this course normally means a present indicative form unless stated otherwise.
- **Vocabulary packets**: meanings are learner glosses, not exhaustive dictionary definitions.

Next recommended phase

After this course: imperative and optative moods; past narration; participles; more noun cases; verbal prefixes in context; and controlled readings from adapted Sanskrit.